



“India can be transformed if all of us take responsibility for it”

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I found it ironical that I have been asked to speak 10 minutes about a generation that lives on text messages and tweets with a 140-character limit. In Godrej, we have realigned ourselves to be highly consumer-centric so I would share with you a few ideas that are very relevant in this context. India's youth today is socially aware and more idealistic than its counterparts elsewhere, but I strongly believe that they are no longer are limited to the ideas that they have inherited from their parents. India today has changed: it is more progressive, brighter, it's a land of opportunity and along with these, the ideals of the youth have also evolved. The concept of idealism has changed. Earlier frugality, restraint, saving and concepts of minimalism were sort of prerequisites to being considered idealistic, but they are no longer important. To touch youth today, one needs to be contemporary and understand this new context they live in. I strongly feel that aspiration and affluence are in no sense idealism's enemies. Entrepreneurship that creates true wealth can be both inclusive and can be done with utter integrity. There is ample opportunity for any employee or any corporate to live and work with utmost integrity and be very successful doing just that. Even in an inclusive sense, it's complete. As a group, I believe that going forward is going to get easier and easier as India today has ample opportunity. In a broader sense, idealism is really critical for the effective working of a democracy. Cynicism and apathy really can't be tolerated as excuses for shrugging off personal responsibility to this cause. There is a great need, as Deepender pointed out, for more personal democratic participation, idealism and personal responsibility for the future. Our nation can be transformed if all of us

(FROM LEFT) PURUSHOTHAMAN, HOODA, DUBASH, THOTTUMKAL, KAPOOR AND D'SOUZA AT THE SESSION

would take responsibility for it. We need to ask ourselves if we can be the change we want to see. If we do so, we would be able to metamorphosise our nation. We should evaluate whether we see our existence as the product of our circumstance or whether we have the motivation to change the circumstance that we live in. If reality asks you to compromise on your ideals, it is time to recreate or renew reality rather than extinguish your ideals because it is only by adhering to your values and ideas that you can create real value.

“Idealism has today paved the way for reality”

RANBIR KAPOOR ACTOR

I represent youngistan, the youth of India. As part of this generation which believes in challenging conventions, I'd like to begin with challenging the topic itself. Why can't reality and idealism come together? Why can't idealism become reality? One of the few cynics thought that the young Indian cricket team would be slaughtered in the 2007 ICC World Twenty20 tournament. Young captain Mahinder Singh Dhoni won the World Cup in style and turned the wish of winning into reality. Had anyone imagined that a politician with Z-class security would leave the safety of his bulletproof car and roam freely on the streets? And all this just to prove a point. He's young and we all know who he is: Rahul Gandhi.

Closer to my profession, five years ago making films like *Firaaq*, *Taare Zameen Par*, *DevD.*, or those that I have fortunately been a part of—*Wake Up Sid*, *Rocket Singh: Salesman of The Year*—was a big challenge. In *Rocket Singh*... I was Rocket Singh who didn't have any grades to boast of. All that